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Cats empty UTEP's bullpen

By TIM O'MARA
Citizen Sportswriter

Maybe the game was best summed up in the bottom of the seventh, when Texas-El Paso baseball coach Andy Cohen walked to the mound to take out his pitcher. He looked at the bullpen, found it empty, and finally waved toward the outfield.

The surprised center fielder, Bob Alsop, looked around, shrugged his shoulders, and then trotted in to pitch.

And the way things went, Alsop wound up with a better performance than any of the other five UTEP hurlers, not that his was all that sparkling. The game really ended in the first inning as the Cats scored eight runs, but when they'd finished all nine, Arizona had won, 27-5, in its first Western Athletic Conference game of the season.

And there was more bad news for the Miners: They have to play the Cats twice today, at 1 p.m. at Wildcat Field, and again tonight at 7.

The victory, Arizona's 45th in WAC play in 49 games with UTEP, gave UA a share of the early conference lead with Arizona State, which defeated New Mexico, 4-1, in its first game in Albuquerque last night. Those two teams were to play a doubleheader today.

Although UA coach Jerry Kindall went to his bench about as early as any coach can, he couldn't very well tell the reserves to strike out, and so Arizona scored in every inning, after an eight-run first.

Glenn Wendt was the hitting star for the Cats, although there were more than enough hot bats to go around. Wendt was four-for-four with two home runs, scored four times and had three runs batted in. Steve Jasco was also 4-for-4 with two doubles.

The two homers, both off curve balls, gave Wendt five for the season — he only had one last year. "That's a nice feeling," said Wendt, who's been hitting much better in the last two weeks. He started slowly this year, but has seen his average climb back above .300 with an eight-game hitting streak.

Wendt, a co-captain on this year's defending national champion team, said he didn't think the easy win could do the Cats a great deal of good, but it wouldn't do any harm, either.

"I don't think we can get overconfident the way we've been playing lately," he said. "We've been inconsistent."

If there is a defense for the Miners, it may be that the game was UTEP's first under the lights this season, and it showed as the fielders seemed to misjudte more fly balls than they caught. UTEP came into the game with its best record in years — 21-9 — but has not played many name opponents in its pre-conference schedule.

Today, Chuck McMichael was to pitch in the first game, with Ray Murillo going in the nightcap. Arizona now stands 28-18-1. The Cats will be idle after today until next weekend, when they go to Albuquerque to meet New Mexico in another three-game WAC series.

* * *

Wildcats 27, Miners 5

UTEP	ab	r	h	bi	Ariz.	ab	r	h	bi
Alsp,cf	5	1	1	0	Zman,cf	4	2	1	0
Cdv,2b	5	1	1	1	Slnly,cf	2	1	1	0
Ewnd,1b	5	1	1	1	Wen,ss	4	1	4	3
Kndz,ss	4	1	2	0	McCnl,2b	2	2	1	1
Dghm,rf	4	0	2	1	Psy,2b ss	5	3	1	0
Bdfld,3b	4	0	0	0	Garet,rf	4	5	2	2
Grae,lf	1	0	0	0	Wdsde,c	3	0	0	0
Ansn,lf	0	0	0	0	Grn,pr	0	1	0	0
Cmr,lf	2	0	0	0	Tadeo c	1	1	1	1
RP,dh cf	3	1	0	0	Itcas	1	1	1	2
Flrs,c	3	0	1	0	Dvrlnd	1	0	1	2
					V Hrn,1b	5	2	1	1
					Murley,lf	4	3	2	2
					Jasco,dh	4	2	4	4
					Ekbrd,dh	1	0	0	1
					Crlsn,1b	4	1	2	2
					Incgrl,2b	0	0	0	0
Totals	36	5	10	3	Totals	47	27	26	25

UTEP	000	300	002	— 5
Arizona	831	134	52x	— 27

E — George, Flores, McConnell, Crutcher 2. LOB — UTEP 8, UA 7. DP — UTEP 1, UA 3. 2b — Jasco 2, Carlsen, Garrett 2. 3b — McConnell, Ladeo, Stanley, Overlund. HR — Wendt 2 (5), Morley (1). SB — Wendt. S —. SF — Van Horne.

UTEP	ip	h	r	er	bb	so
Jnnsch (L, 3-3)	⅓	4	7	7	2	1
Damewrth	1⅔	6	5	5	1	0
Milbrgr	2⅔	6	4	4	0	0
Jarger	⅓	3	2	2	0	0
Rima	1	4	2	2	6	0
Alsop	2	3	2	2	0	1
Arizona						
Crutcher	9	10	5	3	2	8

Save — HBP — Pearsey (by Jannusch and Rima), Kennedy (by Crutcher), Garrett (by Damewarth), Woodside (by Milberger). WP — Damewarth, Crutcher. PB — T — 2:56. A — 2,998.

Inside . . .

Bob Lanier ignored the pain of a broken bone in his hand and sparked the Detroit Pistons to victory last night with 25 points. Story on Page 7A.

Babe Ruth may have hit more home runs, but he didn't hit them any farther than some of those hammered out by Mike Schmidt. Murray Column on Page 9A.

Haven takes big lead in Senior Cup

The Haven Golf Club of Green Valley is threatening to become the first team to run away with the championship in the three-year history of the Tucson Daily Citizen Senior Cup golf tournament.

Captain Bob Chambers received winning efforts from all six Haven players yesterday in the tournament's first round at the Oro Valley Country Club.

Haven scored 39 of a possible 54 points in the tournament format that has each golfer playing three-point matches with each member of his foursome. Each one of the Haven squad had a winning day.

Tucson Country Club stayed within reach with 31 points followed by Randolph's Men's Club, champions of the inaugural tournament in 1975, at 32.

Tucson National Golf Club is fourth at 31½, followed by the Country Club of Green Valley with 30½; 49ers Country Club, the defending champions, 29½; Oro Valley Country Club, 28; Davis-Monthan, 26; Skyline Country Club and Old Pueblo Golf Club, 25½; Hughes Employee Association, and Rolling Hills Country Club, 23; El Rio Men's Club, 16; and Saguaro Golf Club, 14½.

Furm Duncan, Bob Frank, Mac Wagner, Jack Toole, Ted Melson and Chambers comprised Haven's strong outfit. Their range in handicaps is from six to nine, which presents a solid lineup under the format that has two match-play points using handicap and one medal-play point without handicap.

Randolph's Dick Davies was the day's medalist, shooting a par 72 on the 6,650-yard layout. Neil White of the Country Club of Green Valley had a 74 while Bill Bell of Tucson Country Club and Bill Thompson of Tucson National had 76s.

The tournament concludes Monday at the Country Club of Green Valley, with a 9 a.m. start using both tees.

Team scoring:

HAVEN (39) — Furm Duncan 6, Bob Frank 5½, Mac Wagner 6½, Ted Melson 6½, Jack Toole 8, Bob Chambers 6½.

TUCSON COUNTRY CLUB (34) — Bill Bell 9, Walt Holden 4, Wes Becker 5, John Crable 6, Charles Lamb 3, Frank Hardy 6.

RANDOLPH (32) — Dick Davies 7½, Roy Tatum 7, Max Dack 3, B. J. Oliver 5, Ed Haley 4½, Carl Owens 5.

TUCSON NATIONAL (31½) — Bill Thompson 7½, Mead Montgomery 1, Fred Stewart 9, Bob McCabe 5½, Clarence Eichenberger 3, Lloyd Fisher 5½.

C.C. of GREEN VALLEY (30½) — Neil White 7½, Andy Blaine 3½, Marty Lawlor 1½, Vern Johnson 2, Frank Hanson 8, Morrie Robertson 8.

49ers C.C. (29½) — Bill Schumm 5½, Bob Marker 2½, Doug King 3, Leon Gray 9, Al Arsonault 2½, Glenn Johnson 7.

ORO VALLEY C.C. (28) — Art Hyrbee 5, Stan Glinert 3½, Ilch Berkman 5½, Larry Hammond 5, Bill Carn 7, Dick Essenprens 2.

DAVIS MONTHAN (26) — Gene Hambleton 7, Al Sutton 7, George O'Keefe 1½, Gordy Fox 6½, Bill Williams 3, Ef Staunaard 1.

SKYLINE C.C. (25½) — Ward White 4½, C. W. Schumacher 5½, Irving Domnitch 8½, Bud Johnson 1½, Roger Daugherty 0, Bob Sankey 5½.

OLD PUEBLO (25½) — Dan Hubbard 7½, Chito Corellia 5½, Tony Quihuis 2, Rudy Elias 3½, Al Arriaga 3½, Joe Quiroz 8½.

HUGHES (23) — Bob Clements 6, Bill Kyle 3, Don Brayton 1, Gene Wagner 7, Dick Mellinger 8½, Bob Welch 5½.

ROLLING HILLS C.C. (23) — Cy Young 1, Bill Oavern 9, George Carter 0, Al Thornton 5½, Mason Green 4½, Rod Kile 3.

EL RIO (16) — Pete Almada 1, Joe Curiel 2½, Rudy Salazar 2, Nicho Elias 1½, Bob Sandoval 0, Art Aguilar 9.

SAGUARO (14½) — Jack Fahl 5, Vern Biesterfield ½, John Jacobs 3½, George Gustafson 1, John Modus 4½, John Killebrew 0.

UPI Telephoto

Having a blast

Hubert Green has difficulty with the sand in the second round of the Masters golf tournament at Augusta, Ga. Here he blasts out of a bunker on the second hole. Later he was in the sand on No. 12 and knocked it out and into the water for a double bogey that cost him his first-round lead.

Masters leaders not confident

AUGUSTA, Ga. (AP) — Tom Watson refuses to think about winning the Masters golf championship. Rod Funseth can't even picture himself on top.

Like it or not, those two found themselves with a one-stroke lead heading into the third round of this prestigious tournament today at the 7,030-yard Augusta National Golf Club course.

Watson, a young man who knows how to win but also finds ways to give away victories, fashioned a three-under-par 69 yesterday to go with his opening-round 70.

Funseth, a relatively anonymous veteran who doesn't exactly exude self-confidence, birdied four straight holes to carve out a 67 to go with an earlier 72.

Their five-under-par totals of 139 gave them the lead, but 23 of the world's finest players were bunched within five shots of them.

Watson birdied all four par 5s and needed to par the 18th for sole possession of the lead. But he pulled a 5-iron on the 420-yard par 4 and had to settle for bogey.

The 27-year-old Watson, winner of the 1975 British Open, has two victories this season and is the leading money-winner on the tour. But he's also lost leads in the final rounds of two other tournaments, something he's done in past years.

Invariably Watson is asked if he chokes; he says no, it's simply a matter of not having a swing that he's confident will hold up under pressure. He says he has one now, but still won't speculate about where he'll rank tomorrow.

"I won't even think about winning at this point," he said. "I'll just play it shot by shot."

Funseth, a 44-year-old veteran of 17 years on the tour, birdied holes seven through 10 with putts of 10, 4, 4 and 25 feet. He added birdies of 10 feet on No. 2 and 12 feet on No. 15, offset by a single bogey on the third hole.

Scores on Page 8A

A two-time winner since joining the tour in 1961, the Californian calls himself as a good tee-to-green player but a bad putter.

"I've been playing poorly this year," he said after his round. "I really can't picture myself as Masters champion.

"They probably don't have a green jacket that fits me, anyway."

Bill Kratzert, the 24-year-old rookie who claims he isn't awed by the tradition of Augusta National, fired a 71 and liked his chances.

"I'm in a good position to charge," said the young man whom many of the tour veterans consider the best of the crop of young players. "I'm in good shape. Sure, I think of winning."

Bracketed with him was Crenshaw, a 25-year-old who won more than $250,000 last year. His round of 69 was highlighted by an eagle on the 555-yard, par-5 second hole. His second shot, a 1-iron, skipped through a bunker and rolled within 20 feet of the hole.

Green, whose 67 led after the first round, could manage only a 74 yesterday with a round marred by a double-bogey on the difficult 155-yard, par-3 12th hole. Green bunkered his first shot, chipped from there across the green and into a pond, had to drop, try again from the bunker and finally rammed home a 20-foot putt for a five.

"The first ball was deeply buried and I should have played it to the safe side of the green," he said. "I didn't know how to play the shot, and it was stupid to try. You don't practice in a major championship."

Nicklaus took 35 putts on his way to a 70 after taking 37 putts Thursday.

"I've played fairly well for two days but I'm only two under par," Nicklaus said disgustedly. "I'm just three off the lead. I've had my chances to be way out in lead but I'm not. I want to win the golf tournament, darn it, but I won't if I don't start making some putts."

Sun Devils trip Lobos

ALBUQUERQUE, New Mexico (AP) — Third baseman Jamie Allen knocked in two of Arizona State University's first three runs with a ground out and a double to lead the Sun Devils to a 4-1 victory over New Mexico in a Western Athletic Conference baseball game here last night.

ASU, in running its season record to 31-8, grabbed a share of the WAC Southern Division lead in the league opener for both schools. Arizona's 27-5 victory over Texas-El Paso gave the Wildcats a 1-0 conference mark as well.

The Sun Devil triumph was punctuated by three controversial calls by umpire Tom Nicoletti, the final one prompting ASU coach Jim Brock's ejection in the eighth inning.

"In 21 years of coaching, I've never seen any umpire who was dishonest," Brock said, "but the way he (Nicoletti) reacted after some of his calls tonight I would have to say this man is dishonest."

Baseball Scoreboard

American League

EAST

	w	l	pct	gb
Toronto	1	0	1.000	—
Cleveland	1	0	1.000	—
New York	1	0	1.000	—
Detroit	0	1	.000	1
Milwaukee	0	1	.000	1
Boston	0	1	.000	1
Baltimore	0	1	.000	1

WEST

	w	l	pct	gb
Texas	1	0	1.000	—
Kansas City	1	0	1.000	—
California	2	1	.667	—
Seattle	1	2	.333	1
Minnesota	0	0	.000	½
Oakland	0	0	.000	½
Chicago	0	1	.000	1

Yesterday
Seattle 7, California 6
Only game scheduled

Today
Chicago (Knapp 3-1) at Toronto (Lemanczyk 4-6)
Texas (Perry 15-14) at Baltimore (May 15-10)
Milwaukee (Slaton 14-15 or Augustine 9-12) at New York (Figueroa 19-10)
Cleveland (Fitzmorris 15-11) at Boston (Cleveland 10-9)
Kansas City (Hassler 5-12) at Detroit (Bare 7-8)
Minnesota (Goltz 14-14) at Oakland (Torrez 16-12)
California (Simpson 0-0) at Seattle (Wheelock 0-0)

National League

EAST

	w	l	pct	gb
New York	1	0	1.000	—
St. Louis	1	0	1.000	—
Montreal	0	0	.000	½
Philadelphia	0	0	.000	½
Chicago	0	1	.000	1
Pittsburgh	0	1	.000	1

WEST

	w	l	pct	gb
Cincinnati	2	0	1.000	—
Los Angeles	1	0	1.000	½
Houston	1	0	1.000	½
Atlanta	0	1	.000	1½
San Francisco	0	1	.000	1½
San Diego	0	2	.000	2

Yesterday
Cincinnati 6, San Diego 3
Houston 3, Atlanta 2, 11 innings
Only games scheduled

Today
Montreal (Rogers 7-17) at Philadelphia (Carlton 20-7)
New York (Matlack 17-10) at Chicago (Krukow 0-0)
St. Louis (Forsch 8-10) at Pittsburgh (Kison 14-9)
San Diego (Freisleben 10-13) at Cincinnati (Norman 12-7)
Atlanta (Niekro 17-11) at Houston (Andujar 9-10)
San Francisco (Barr 15-12) at Los Angeles (Rau 16-12)

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